

feel right that three generations of a smartphone have been using the same exact chip and without any changes in how they perform or the architecture.

In GPU benchmarks also, the story remains the same. We get similar scores with the Vivo V30 Pro as compared to its predecessor, or its predecessor's predecessor. There are some differences here and there obviously, but the overall performance remains on the same scale.

So performance-wise, there is nothing as such to note here. The Vivo V30 Pro performs very similar to its predecessors. Although the upgrade isn't there, the MediaTek Dimensity 8200 still remains powerful enough to handle all the camera smarts and features that Vivo has put in the new Vivo V30 Pro.

CAMERA

Coming to the hero of the story, the camera. This is where the Vivo V30 Pro showcases its superiority. This is the first V-series smartphone which boasts of Zeiss superpowers in the camera department. We all have seen what Vivo and Zeiss have been able to create in the last couple of years with the Vivo X80, Vivo X90 and the Vivo X100 series. This time, the brand has brought a lot of that to the premium mid-range segment.

So we get a triple rear camera setup with a 50-megapixel primary shooter, a 50-megapixel ultra-wide angle lens, and a 50-megapixel telephoto lens which enables 4x telephoto zoom. Now with the rear primary camera, the Vivo V30 Pro clicks great pictures regardless of how the light and environment is. The colours are nice and consistent, photos are sharp, and the images have great dynamic range.

The images out of the wide angle lens are also crisp and sharp, which is great, since there is little to no difference between the quality of images from the primary shooter and the wide angle lens. I put consistency above anything when it comes to the quality of images from each of the shooters, so here also the Vivo V30 Pro fared pretty well.

Coming to the telephoto lens, this is also very good. Firstly, I appreciate getting 4x optical zoom in this range of smart-

phones. No other smartphone in this range offers this so here the Vivo V30 Pro already gets the points in my book. But that is not all. Not only is the quality of images really good, the 4x shots (92mm) are crisp and super detailed in all lighting conditions. A pretty good flex for a premium mid-ranger to be able to do that.

The portraits on the Vivo V30 Pro are also brilliant. Here, Vivo has brought its partnership with Zeiss into play, meaning we get all the Zeiss portrait styles like Zeiss Biotar, Zeiss Sonar, Zeiss Planar, and more in the Vivo V30 Pro. Each of these are as good as on Vivo's flagship, the Vivo X100 Pro. Worth mentioning, the edge detection, background blur, and sharpness on the portraits are brilliant. And yes, Vivo has kept the famous "wedding mode" which has been a hit since the Vivo V27 series.

Then again, there's the Aura Light. This time, we get a large, squared aura light which solves the same purpose as the one we have seen on the Vivo V29 Pro. We can change the Aura Light's colours from cool to warm to adjust the colour bleed in our photos and it works! In a room which may be too blue or red, or may have any harsh lighting, you can still make your photos nice and balanced by using Aura Light. It works really well and especially for our creator friends, this is a blessing. Not only in terms of balancing the light and making things appear in their true colour, it can also be used to get some very cool video shots.

So the camera on the Vivo V30 Pro is killer. This is probably one of the best cameras available at a price of under Rs 45,000 in the Android space and that itself should tell you that Vivo's decision of bringing Zeiss' superpowers to the Vivo V30 Pro has worked well, at least in terms of pure output.

VERDICT

So the Vivo V30 Pro is a pretty decent smartphone. We have seen a pretty significant price jump this year, since the smartphone starts at a price of Rs 41,999 in India and for that, it can't be called a simple mid-ranger anymore. But that's no problem. Because this camera even outperforms a lot of Android flagships of today.

Be it in terms of the quality or in terms of the number of features available, this is no doubt a brilliant camera phone.

However, there are caveats. First and foremost, the thing that has bothered me a lot is that this is the third generation of Vivo V-series smartphones that have had the same exact processor, meaning that the performance has not improved since the Vivo V27 Pro. Furthermore, there is no stereo speaker on the Vivo V30 Pro, so for those who just put up things to watch without headphones, the experience isn't very immersive.

And then there are the nit pickings. Like the Vivo V30 Pro is super slim (good), but at the same time it feels super fragile (bad). There's a kickass camera setup that goes well beyond your expectations of a mid-range camera (good), but there's no expandable storage (bad). And although 512GB is enough storage, there are people who would want to buy a lower storage variant and get a microSD card for more storage.

So yes, the Vivo V30 Pro justifies its value with the camera and the look and feel. But then again, we are getting the same chip as the one we got in the previous two V-series smartphones. We aren't getting the best display out there. It is vibrant, but not very accurate in terms of colour.

So my verdict is a bit confusing. If you want a flagship-level camera without spending money on a flagship phone, the Vivo V30 Pro is for you. If you want a party trick with the Aura Light or want to flaunt your style, the Vivo V30 Pro is for you. But if you are someone who wants the best value for money without caring much about the camera and style, then there are better options available at a lesser price.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: MediaTek Dimensity 8200 | GPU: Mali-G610 MC6 | OS: Funtouch OS 14 based on Android 14 | Display: 6.78-inch FHD+ AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 512GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 50MP + 50MP | Cameras (front): 50MP | Video: 4K @ 30fps | Battery: 5000mAh | Charging: 80W

CONTACT

Phone: 1800-208-3388 | Email: Online form (<https://www.vivo.com/in>)